Nominations for 2017 Breakthrough and New Horizons Prizes now open

Terence Tao · 2 March 2016

https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2016/03/02/nominations-for-2017-breakthrough-and-new-horizons-prizes-now-open/

tao2typ · converted to Typst 2026-10-14 (UTC)

Nominations for the 2017 Breakthrough Prize in mathematics and the New Horizons Prizes in mathematics are now open. In 2016, the Breakthrough Prize was awarded to Ian Agol. The New Horizons prizes are for breakthroughs given by junior mathematicians, usually restricted to within 10 years of PhD; the 2016 prizes were awarded to Andre Neves, Larry Guth, and Peter Scholze (declined).

The rules for the prizes are listed on this page, and nominations can be made at this page. (No self-nominations are allowed, for the obvious reasons; also, a third-party letter of recommendation is also required.)

Comments (10)

RicPed · 3 March 2016

I'm a little curious now, what are (usually) the main reasons behind a refusal of a prize?

> **Noel Gardeli** · 13 March 2016
>
> I just hope Scholze doesn't decline the Fields Medal for 2018, so that I will see him here in Brazil! (at least, according to https://www.quora.com/What-are-your-predictions-for-the-2018-Fields-Medals , he is a favourite)

John Mangual · 3 March 2016

I found many passages in Hatcher's "Algebraic Topology" hard-going. Especially when he constructs homology and cohomolgy. Really, Chapter 0 (and bits of 1) have sufficed for a long time :-)

Anonymous · 3 March 2016

I wanted to nominate D.H.J. Polymath for the New Horizons prize but the form requires email registration. Oh well.

> **Anonymous** · 5 March 2016
>
> Perhaps also Nicolas Bourbaki.

Anonymous · 4 March 2016

Yitang Zhang is the definition of breakthrough prize.

João Rimu · 5 March 2016

From the rules: "The Breakthrough Prize in Mathematics recognizes a single person's contribution to the field of mathematics, with special attention to recent developments (Contribution to the field of mathematics in the last 10 years, although earlier contributions may also be taken into account)."
This is interesting, and it makes easier to predict who will win.
What where the top mathematical achievements in the last ten years?
In fact, Yitang Zhang is a very serious contender. Specially considering the latest prize was for work topology.

João Rimu · 5 March 2016

My prediction for the New Horizons Prize:
James Maynard (Ph.D. from 2013)
John Pardon (Ph.D. from 2015)
Corinna Ulcigrai (Ph.D. from 2007)
What do you guys think about it? :D

MMP · 16 December 2017

I think the time is for the works related to à la "Einstein" to make universe great again
https://vote.pollcode.com/64327489
Peter Scholze
Simon Brendle
Hugo Duminil-Copin
Hassan Jolany
John Pardon
Péter Varjú

Wei Zhang
Adrian Ioana
Subhash Khot

Anonymous · 25 February 2025

Right now Mark Zuckerberg is aligning with Trump agenda (at least partially) by disowning DEI initiatives.
Would this be morally enough for you to give back the Breakthrough Prize or step down from the committee (https://breakthroughprize.org/Committee/3) or at least morally clarify your position in the bigger scheme of things?
We have come a long way from the ends justify the means.